Households and Teachers

The Obedience of Faith → Completed

"teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And remember, I am with you always, to the end of the age."
(Matthew 28:20)

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The Household: The First Congregation

God's order reaches into the home → and everyone has a post

Before the assembly, the home. The faith is handed down at the kitchen table: ***"These words… must be kept on your heart. Teach them to your children and speak of them… when you sit at home, when you walk along the road, when you lie down, and when you get up."*** **(Deut 6:6–7)**
On the heart FIRST → then on the lips. You cannot hand down what you do not hold.

It is why Abraham was chosen: ***"so that he may command his children and his household after him to keep the way of the LORD"*** **(Gen 18:19)** And Joshua: "as for me and my household, we will serve the LORD" (Josh 24:15).

In a mixed household, everyone carries a post → not fathers only:

- Husbands & wives → love as Christ loved; "so that your prayers will not be hindered" (Eph 5:25; 1 Pet 3:7)
- Fathers & mothers → raise them "in the instruction of the Lord" (Eph 6:4); older women teach younger (Titus 2)
- Grandparents & singles → Timothy's faith came through Lois & Eunice, a grandmother and mother (2 Tim 1:5)

Notice 1 Peter 3:7 → how you treat your family is wired to your access to God: love badly at home, and "your prayers will be hindered." The household is not a break from worship. It is worship's proving ground → where the living sacrifice is offered first.

The Pattern, One Last Time

Receive and hand on → never invent

The whole course has taught one motion: you don't generate the faith → you RECEIVE it and HAND IT ON. Deposit and handoff (Week 10), in the church and in the home alike. The parent, like the apostle, passes on what was entrusted, not what he invented.

***"what you heard from me… entrust to faithful people who will be competent to teach others"* (2 Tim 2:2)**

Paul → Timothy → faithful people → others. And Timothy → from Lois & Eunice. The relay runs through pulpits AND kitchens.

And the blemished-lamb question (Week 9) comes home too:

If the time and attention you give your household this week were an animal brought to Malachi's altar → what condition would it be in? The best of the flock, or the exhausted leftover? *"I will not offer… sacrifices that cost me nothing" (2 Sam 24:24) → and the people under your roof are where the cost is realest.*

This is discipleship's ordinary shape: not a platform or a title, but a life received in trust and handed to the next person → a child, a friend, a new believer, a grandchild. Everyone in this room is a link in a relay that reaches back to the apostles and forward past your lifetime.

The Commission: The Course Completed

Matthew 28 → and "by this time you ought to be teachers"

*"All **authority** in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore **go** and make **disciples** of all nations, **baptizing** them… and **teaching** them to **obey** everything I have commanded you. And remember, I am with you always, to the end of the age."* **(Matthew 28:18–20)**

Hear the course's own title in the Lord's last command: "teaching them to OBEY." Discipleship's goal is not merely believers who agree → it is the obedience of faith (Rom 1:5), in Jesus' own words.

And the rebuke that opened this course now resolves into a calling:
"though you should in fact be teachers by this time, you need someone to teach you the beginning elements…" **(Heb 5:12)**
Week 1, that verse was a rebuke. Today it is a commission → because now you have the meal to serve.

Notice the bookends of grace: the command to teach opens with "all authority is given to ME" and closes with "I am WITH you always." You are sent under His authority and in His company → never on your own steam.

The Stack, Completed in Christ

Everything asked in twelve weeks rests on this

"a body you prepared for me… "Here I am: I have come… to do your will, O God."… by his will we have been made holy through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all." **(Hebrews 10:5, 7, 10)**

Obedience of Faith → "I have come to do your will"

Sacrifice → the full cost, nothing kept back

Worship → perfect heart

Religion → perfect form

Aligned once, completely, in Him.

The four layers we stacked in Week 2 → form, disposition, cost, settled pattern → were held perfectly by Christ, once for all.

He completed the stack before He asked you to climb it. Your sacrifice is a thank offering, never a payment.

Mercy first. Altar second.

Discussion

Ten minutes → the last practice

1. Who taught the faith to you → and what did it cost them? Name one person, and one thing they gave up.

2. Whom will YOU teach → and what is the one concrete first step you'll take this month?

The Charge

Offer your sacrifices with the obedience of faith

The course's standing assignment does not end today → it begins in earnest:
One chapter. Before the phone. Your first minutes, not your last → the unblemished ones. Eager, and examining. Lay the mind on the altar and let God keep training your eyes.

The whole course, in one breath:
The Good is God's own character (W1). Sacrifice makes worship visible (W2). Sincerity is not enough (W3). Righteousness is a gift (W4). Discernment is trained (W5–6). Every covenant tests faith (W7–9). Authority is received, and order serves communion (W10–11). And maturity's destination is to teach (W12).

You began being asked, "Why do you call me good?" **You end being told, "Go… teaching them to obey." From the question, to the commission.**

Offer your sacrifices with the Obedience of Faith.

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